# Customer Behavior Story: Codefi Farm Financial Planning

## Customer Profile

**Primary Persona:** Mid-scale commodity farmer (500–5,000 acres), Midwest, typically 40–60 years old, managing multi-generational family operation.

**Demographics:** - Farm size: 500–5,000 acres (corn/soybean focus) - Region: Midwest (Missouri, Iowa, Illinois, Indiana primary) - Tech adoption: Digitally-forward relative to peers; already using co-op apps, DTN pricing

**Psychographics:** - Values: Family legacy, professional autonomy, financial security for next generation - Frustrations: Flying blind on input decisions, fragmented data sources, inability to see margin impact in real-time - Aspirations: Run farm like a true business; command respect as a financially disciplined operator; leave legacy of competence, not crisis

## Jobs to Be Done

**Functional Job:** Make high-stakes input timing and pricing decisions with confidence, seeing exactly how cost changes impact field-level profitability before committing tens of thousands of dollars.

**Emotional Job:** Shift from feeling like a guesser (relying on gut instinct, anecdotes, fragmented data) to feeling like a professional operator commanding full visibility into farm finances.

**Social Job:** Be perceived by family, neighbors, and lenders as a competent steward capable of running a financially disciplined operation and passing a solvent farm to the next generation.

**Trigger Event:** Input cost spike (fertilizer, seed, fuel), commodity price volatility, or a recent bad decision that cost $40K+ — moment when current approach feels dangerously inadequate.

## Push Forces (Current Situation Pain)

**Primary Pain Points:** - Decision paralysis: Committing $50K–$100K+ based on gut instinct, neighbor gossip, agronomist with sales incentive - Invisible cost structure: Can't quickly answer "What's my actual breakeven on this field at $4.20 corn?" - Asymmetric risk: Thin margins mean one bad call wipes profitability; they see the risk but can't prevent it

**Frustration Threshold:** After a recent loss ($40K–$60K from wrong timing) or watching prices move

30% against them while they did nothing.

**Hidden Costs:** Hours lost managing fragmented data (spreadsheets, notebooks, phone calls); mental load of carrying financial uncertainty; opportunity cost of missed insights (field-level underperformance, cash flow mismatches).

## Pull Forces (Solution Attraction)

**Desired Outcomes:** - See one critical decision clearly before it's too late ("breakeven answer in 2 minutes, not 2 days") - Understand which fields leak money, which over-perform, and why - Make input decisions backed by data, not worry - Know how their costs compare to peer farms (competitive awareness)

**Magnetic Features:** Fast scenario modeling ("What if corn is $4.20?"), per-field P&L clarity, benchmarking that shows where they leak money vs. neighbors, historical tracking to learn from past seasons.

**Success Vision:** Open Codefi pre-season as first planning step; confidently explain input decisions to lender; sleep better knowing margin picture is clear; pass farm to next generation with documented financial discipline, not crisis.

## Anxiety Forces (Switching Concerns)

**Top Concerns:** - Data entry burden: "I don't have time to set this up and feed it data all season" - Trust gap: "Will this tool actually understand my farm? Every farm is different" - Privacy risk: "Will my cost structure leak to competitors or lenders?" - ROI proof: "How do I know this saves me money before I commit $150/month for a year?"

**Risk Perception:** Wasted time on setup that doesn't deliver; tool too generic for ag reality; financial data exposure.

**Trust Barriers:** Need proof tool works for farmers by farmers; need clear, fast first win; need ironclad data security.

**Anxiety Reducers:** Free pilot with extension office/co-op endorsement; one-click scenario modeling (minimal data entry); clear first-30-day win (one decision made better); transparent security + anonymized benchmarking.

## Habit Forces (Status Quo Comfort)

**Current Behaviors:** - Call agronomist/co-op rep when facing decision (familiar, trusted relationship) - Check DTN prices and commodity futures (daily habit) - Talk to neighbor at co-op or coffee shop (social ritual, free advice) - Manage spreadsheet or notebook for rough cost tracking (laborious but familiar)

**Switching Costs:** - Time: Learning curve + initial data entry (perceived as hours, actual is minutes) - Money: $150/month + risk of tool not working out - Social: Lender might question why switching tools; agronomist relationship may feel disrupted

**Inertia Factors:** Spreadsheet is free (zero out-of-pocket); agronomist relationship is personal and trusted; existing tools (DTN, QuickBooks) already in workflow; status quo feels safer than trying new system.

## Decision Journey

**Awareness:** Word-of-mouth from extension office or co-op rep; conversation with early-adopter neighbor; mention from lender.

**Consideration:** Asks for demo focused on one live scenario (not product tour); wants to see if tool answers their actual question; evaluates data privacy and ease of first scenario run.

**Decision:** Happens when they can run one live scenario in pilot, see the answer in under 3 minutes, and feel confident about privacy. Committed by endorsement from trusted partner (extension, co-op, lender).

**Adoption:** First 30 days critical — must surface one decision insight that prevents a mistake or confirms a smart call. Without early win, tool gets abandoned.

**Loyalty:** Shifts to habit (pre-season ritual) by Month 6; stickiness becomes historical record + benchmarking competitive awareness by Month 12+.

**Key Influencers:** Extension agents, co-op managers, agricultural lenders, trusted neighbors (early adopters).

## Messaging Strategy

**Core Message:** "See your farm's financial reality. Make one better decision this season."

**Push Messaging (Amplify Pain):** "You're making $50K decisions with fragmented data. One bad call costs you $40K–$60K. Stop guessing."

**Pull Messaging (Paint Future):** "Know your breakeven in 2 minutes. See which fields leak money.

Run scenarios before committing. Operate like a true business owner."

**Anxiety Reduction:** "Your data stays private. Start with one scenario — no hours of setup. Built by ag experts, tested with farmers."

**Habit Breaking:** "Open Codefi first, not last. Make it your pre-season planning ritual."

**Proof Points Needed:** Case study from respected local farmer showing $X decision improved; endorsement from extension office or co-op; free pilot with transparent data security; video showing 2-minute scenario run.

## Implementation Insight

The farmer's psychology hinges on identity and credibility. They're not buying a tool; they're buying back their sense of professional competence and control over a multi-generational asset. Every feature, every message, every touchpoint must reinforce this: You are capable of running this farm intelligently. Codefi gives you the visibility to prove it — to yourself, your family, your lender, and your neighbors. The benchmarking element is uniquely sticky because it shifts their self-perception from isolated guesser to regionally-aware operator. That identity shift is irreversible and creates 18+ month stickiness.